

RAJAT KULSHRESHTHA

Engineering Manager

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SUMMARY

Engineering Manager with 11 years at PayPal building and running high-scale, consumer- and merchant-facing product platforms. Directly led **10+ engineers** (30+ across the product) and **cross-geo, distributed teams** of frontend, backend, mobile and QA engineers at **99.995% availability with zero P0/P1s**. Hands-on in Java, Spring Boot and microservices, with strong architecture, security and operational ownership. Led the adoption of **AI-assisted, agentic engineering** (Claude) and shipped **AI-enabled tools** used daily by engineering teams. Partners with Product Managers and stakeholders on direction and outcomes; builds **high-performing teams** through coaching and hiring. **PayPal Trailblazer Award** (Innovation Architect, 2025).

CORE SKILLS

Leadership: Engineering management, people management and coaching, hiring and performance management, cross-geo (distributed) team leadership across frontend, backend, mobile and QA, roadmapping and OKRs, stakeholder and product partnership, agile delivery, leading through change and ambiguity.

Engineering: System architecture, microservices, REST and GraphQL APIs, security, observability and alerting, operational ownership, performance and scalability, legacy modernisation, ROI-driven technology decisions, AI-assisted and agentic engineering.

Technology: Java, Spring Boot, SQL, Kafka, Docker, Git, Jenkins, Claude, Datadog, Splunk, OpenAPI/Swagger.

EXPERIENCE

PayPal India Private Limited, Bengaluru, India

Jul 2015 – Sep 2026

Manager, Software Development (Engineering Manager), Activity Services

Jul 2022 – Sep 2026

- **Directly managed 10+ engineers** for 4+ years and led 30+ engineers in an end-to-end full-stack product model, delivering **90+ product, 25+ strategic, 35+ security** and 10+ tech-excellence and innovation initiatives. Owned transaction listing, search and details APIs across PayPal UX, powering **32%+ in-app and 27%+ email engagement** in post-transaction experiences.

AI-assisted engineering and AI-enabled products

- Led the team's adoption of **AI-assisted engineering practices**: set up innovation processes to avoid duplicate AI use cases across the org and built a shared context layer ("LLM Wiki": repo conventions, coding standards, architecture rules, domain documentation) so AI agents act as domain experts, refined through feedback.
- Built an **agentic SDLC workflow with Claude**: plugins for architecture and planning, feature development and PR review, starting from Jira requirements and built bottom-up from single-purpose agents. **30%+ faster requirements-to-review**; lets developers new to our systems contribute; now being tested on system bugs.
- Shipped **AI-enabled colleague-facing tools**: a domain-support Slack bot (**60% less developer time** on domain questions, **70% shorter wait** for first response from other teams, including cross-geo); Datadog and Splunk alert triage that analyses deviations against code, recent rollouts and downstream dependencies; a Jira agent that turns sprint-planning documents into stories with acceptance criteria (**40%+ less Jira effort** per person); and a Slack bot that turns daily reflections into weekly kudos and monthly growth summaries.
- **Modernised 7 externalised legacy APIs** (15+ years old, 30M+ daily merchant queries) to Java using AI, with **zero P0/P1 impact**: 99.99% fewer failures, 60M insecure data retrievals/day and 90% Op-ex removed. AI in the SDLC delivered a 50% productivity uplift and stronger security.

Product delivery and cross-geo distributed teams

- Led 13 cross-geo engineers across frontend, backend, mobile and QA, partnering with 6 domain teams across AMER, EMEA and APAC, to build **Rewards in the Activity feed** of the redesigned PayPal Oslo app (**22%+ engagement**): 8+ reward variations in 10+ use cases, 4M+ records/day and 200M+ backfilled records. Unified Synchrony-powered Cashback and Credit transactions with rewards in one experience.
- Nominated by Senior Director+ to lead a cross-geo 7+ engineer team across backend, web and app building a scalable platform for PayPal's **highest-priority anti-spam initiative**; delivered **a month ahead of target**.
- Instituted **Product–Program–Engineering syncs** (OKRs, risk and resource planning) so leads represent the team independently across stakeholders. Led 70%+ of inbound intake, accelerating program alignment 50%+; guided 120+ product requesters to prioritise by ROI within compliance and governance; aligned architects on 8 tech initiatives (2023–2026).

Reliability, security and performance

- **Owned operations**: sustained **99.995% availability** with zero P0/P1s and low client-facing latency; built exception-handling, alerting and triage processes; supported 500+ Jira tickets and 1.5k+ queries.

- Re-architected a **Tier-1 system** for **8x throughput**, **USD 300K+/year savings**, 450+ fewer VMs, 50% lower latency and CPU and 90% fewer garbage-collection runs per hour; built a shadow framework for low-risk re-architecture; introduced distributed caching that removed **2.75B outbound calls/day** and freed 1k+ VMs.
- Led multi-year initiatives that cut legacy platform cost and lifted performance 20%+ (p99 under 8 seconds on Activities cached data).

People, process and stakeholders

- **Built and grew the team:** hired 10, promoted 3 and repositioned 2 engineers; ran monthly 1:1s with structured feedback and strengths-based assessment; onboarded 5 interns (all secured pre-placement offers); **Glint performance score 91/100**, 14 points above PayPal management and highest in the Consumer org (2023).
- Raised **sprint throughput 25%+ and say-do ratio 70%+**; cleared a 3-year-old backlog of 100+ tickets and won back 10+ merchants (USD 5M+ payment volume).
- Resolved issues for high-volume merchants (Google, Apple, Meta, Plaid, Shopify and others) with cross-functional teams, recognised as “One PayPal in Action”. Briefed senior executives weekly; presented to the CTO, CIO and VPs, including hosting a CTO talk.

Member of Technical Staff 1, Activity Services

Mar 2022 – Jun 2022

- Led the migration of “Actions in Activities” from strong to eventual consistency: **70% lower latency**, **USD 480K/year saved**, 1B+ daily real-time API calls and 6B+ daily SQL queries removed, four-nines availability.
- Launched **GraphQL**-based loading on the Activities detail page (1+ s latency and 60+ real-time API calls removed). Replaced ES infrastructure usage for “Did you mean” search with equivalent functionality on existing platform capabilities: **USD 220K/year saved**, zero customer impact.

Software Engineer 3, Activity Services

Feb 2020 – Mar 2022

- Managed **15+ engineers** for 1.5 years to **decommission 4 legacy services** (15+ years old): USD 700K/year infrastructure saved, 100K+ lines of code removed, 25x+ faster in 7 searches.
- Led 8 engineers on **X-Geo enablement**: regulatory-compliant data migration for millions of customers, **China financial-audit** compliance (30+ points of contact) and the launch of PayPal payments products in China.
- Cut Search API latency **20x** with a parallelised database read pattern (team of 3) and redesigned “Actions in Activities” for **3x lower latency** (3.5 s to under 1 s). Platform owner with 500+ code reviews.

Software Engineer 2, Activity Services

Feb 2017 – Feb 2020

- Directed 5 engineers building **Enterprise Audit** for large merchants in 10+ economies; ran development of the team’s externalised APIs on the PayPal developer portal and rectified 50+ product issues.
- Cut time to market **3x** with self-serve coded architecture and fixed defects for **100x faster** filtering; built a Refund credit ETA tracker (5K fewer daily customer contacts) and a CI jobs dashboard (10K+ developer hours saved); recovered USD 100K/year of legacy cost.
- Drove platform integrations with Android Pay, Samsung Pay and Apple; led a **security upgrade** (client authentication and classification-based data encryption in transit).

Software Engineer 1, Activity Services

Jul 2015 – Feb 2017

- Migrated 2 customer-facing APIs (300M+ daily requests) to a new stack, **cutting deployment time 97.5%**.
- Primary contact for P0/P1 issues from Intuit, Google, Microsoft and Facebook (100+ Jira issues); delivered Funds-In-Funds-Out platform integrations with Google, Xoom, Skype and Facebook within a month.

EDUCATION

Indian Institute of Technology Guwahati, Assam, India

2011 – 2015

B.Tech, Electronics and Electrical Engineering, Minor in Computer Science and Engineering; GPA 8.93/10; Institute Silver Medal (highest cumulative performance index in EEE, 2015 batch).

CERTIFICATIONS, AWARDS AND LANGUAGES

- **PayPal Trailblazer Award**, Innovation Architect category (2025).
- **Professional Diploma in Coaching and Mentoring**, Kingstown College, Ireland (Distinction, 81/100), Nov 2024 – Jun 2025.
- PayPal Manager Benchmark Certification, “Managing at PayPal Successfully” (2024).
- PayPal Star of the Month (2021, USD 680K annual savings from legacy migration), Heroes (2020), 20+ Props!, 12 Spot Rewards and 11 Bravo! recognitions.
- 1st in PayPal Bangalore SecForce cyber-security championship (2019); PayPal Agile Championship Program (2019, 50+ participants).
- English: IELTS 7.5/9 (CEFR C1).

Additional material: drive.google.com/drive/folders/13Bf0HafvCIkevoNJ00SZOg74DJxv4I3P